

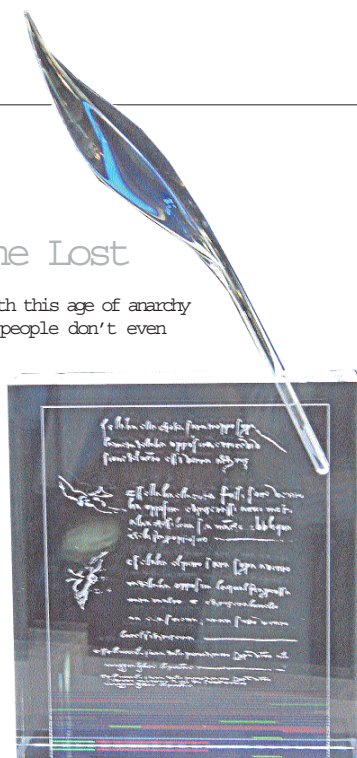


Return To The Lost Art

Clearly disappointed with this age of anarchy and blasphemy where people don't even remember what their own handwriting looks like, NEC decided to bring back this ancient art with the Plume - a feather-shaped quill that combines the joys of handwriting with the security of digital storage.

NEC says "We used digital technology to design this tool to enjoy the beauty of writing and to rediscover the importance and wonder of taking time for contemplation."

After you have written to your fill and inserted the Plume into its main body, your information magically appears on its transparent display and gets stored in the digital format.



Origami

The idea that folded and

Bill Gates' vision of an ultra-mobile device that costs less than \$500 runs multimedia and games and lasts a whole day on a single battery charge is finally here!

Microsoft partnered with Samsung to present the Q1 Ultra-Mobile PC (UMPC) at CeBIT this year. This very attractive device runs Windows XP tablet edition on a 7-inch LCD touchscreen and does everything it's supposed to - music, video, you name it. There's also an on-screen keyboard, designed to be used with your

thumbs.

There's one slight catch - price estimates for the Q1 place it at 1000 Euros (that's about Rs 54,000, which pokes Bill's vision in the eye), and instead of a battery that lasts the whole day, you'll be treated to this personal digital extravaganza for a whole three hours. It would still be forgivable if it did cool stuff like prepare your meals, but when it comes down to it, there's nothing in the Q1 that today's cheaper devices don't already have.



Beyond The Ultimate

Think you're sitting pretty with that all-new SLI motherboard and all of 4 GB of RAM? Your rig is a mere calculator when pitted against Tyan's ultimate gaming PC. Sadly, they don't say much about this, preferring to bill their baby a "Server" - ugh.

The FT48 (for that is what it's called) can hold four dual-core Opterons and has sixteen DIMM slots, four 8x or two 16x PCIe slots and comes SLI ready. It guzzles power from four power supplies that supply it with a respectable 1350W. With the 4 GB memory modules that you can obtain today, this machine can hold up to 64GB of RAM!

Wonder what it would take to push this one to its limit - how do you test a machine that can make Doom3 look like PacMan?



Snug And A Bug

James Bond wannabes will kindly assemble at the doors of Interactive Wear AG for their "Know Where Jacket" that can be tracked via GPS to any corner of the world - even inside buildings!

This surprisingly fashionable item of clothing comes with a cell phone, MP3 Player, headphones, a microphone and Bluetooth, and you can control everything from the keypad on the sleeve. The shoulder contains a GPS antenna which broadcasts your location in real-time, and will ensure that your boss always knows where you are.

Obviously not something you'll want to take with you on a stolen vacation.



Think it Type it

After countless sci-fi movies about them, thought-controlled devices are now more of a reality than ever. The brains at the Fraunhofer Institute for Computer Architecture and Software Technology have come up with the Brain Computer Interface - the name is suggestive enough. The device uses 128 scalp electrodes to analyse brainwaves and translate them into cursor movements on a screen. In its current stage, it will still take you about ten minutes to think out a sentence,

but at least the promise is there.

The researchers hope that this device will eventually help the disabled - even the completely paralysed - communicate with the world around them. And after this noble cause has been accomplished, the device will facilitate the descent of the lazy into a self-induced paralysis.

